



Position Description – Civilian Grades 15-17 (Lead Leaders)

Position	Projects Officer
Position number	Various
Unit	Defence Estate and Infrastructure
Location	Multiple locations
Reports to	Deputy Director Delivery or Project Delivery Team Leader
Direct reports	Nil
Grade	16
Security clearance	CV
Date completed	14 June 2021

About the New Zealand Defence Force

Every hour of every day, 365 days of the year, the New Zealand Defence Force is contributing to the defence, security and well-being of Aotearoa / New Zealand. As a modern, professional military, it is our goal to maintain well trained, equipped and disciplined armed forces that can react to crisis at short notice. Therefore we lead, train and equip our sailors, soldiers and airmen and women for action in the most demanding environments, so they are ready and able to protect New Zealand's interests.

Although we are prepared for combat, our technical skills, professional training, and high-end military equipment lend versatility to a range of security and humanitarian tasks. Our Defence Force is constantly working in partnership with many other government agencies, helping people and protecting our territory and our oceans. We are also striving as a Defence Force to work smarter and it is our purpose to continuously find ways to be better at what we do.

As the nature of combat and our other roles change, we are adapting and planning for the future. All of this is a collective effort, and together we, as members of the Regular Forces, Reserve Forces and Civil Staff – are greater than the sum of our individual parts. Together we are a Force for New Zealand.

Unit Purpose

Estate and infrastructure are critical enablers for the delivery of NZDF military capabilities and the support it provides to other government agencies and the community.

The current NZDF estate is a complex network of approximately 81,000 hectares and 5,000 buildings spread across nine camps and bases, two large land training areas and various regional locations.

The purpose of Defence Estate and Infrastructure (DEI) is to develop, maintain and manage land and infrastructure assets to support NZDF military capabilities and all of government outcomes.

Position Purpose

The Projects Officer manages and leads capital and operating funded projects (up to \$5 million in value) at the regional and base/camp level. The role requires the use of project management methodologies and multi-stakeholder management to ensure that Estate and Infrastructure projects support the delivery of NZDF outputs in the Region.

The role is responsible for input into project development and planning and then, once approval has been provided, ensuring that the allocated capital and operating funded projects are delivered to their successful conclusion.



Key Activities

Major Area of Work	Deliverables/Outcomes
Key Functional Outcomes	• The effective and successful delivery of allocated projects, meeting compliance requirements and resulting in positive outcomes. • Effective performance of project tasks, including project planning, project budget management, reporting, site supervision, quality control, contract documentation, tender evaluation, and contract management culminating in successful project delivery. • The effective management of project files, documents and artefacts in accordance with Project Management Office (PMO) requirements and Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), ensuring that all salient project related information is captured, and stored, in a format that enables effective retrieval.
Systems and Processes Objectives	• The active participation in project planning and reviews to assist in prioritising the use of project resources. • The fostering of continuous improvement to systems and processes to provide value added services to customers. • The implementation of communication strategies to ensure appropriate information sharing and monitoring across customer groups within the Camp or Base, and to the Facilities Operations, where necessary. • The leading of project control groups to ensure all project resources are being utilised in the most efficient and effective manner and project delivery schedules are maintained, issues are captured and resolved and risks are identified and appropriately treated or escalated. • Maintaining a close-working relationship with Facilities Operations staff to ensure project issues are appropriately communicated.
Customer Service and Satisfaction	• The provision of effective project communications and progress/financial reporting to ensure that all stakeholders are kept fully updated, delivering a high level of customer satisfaction. • The effective communications and progress/financial reporting within the Facilities Group with respect to capital projects delivery, resulting in a high level of inter-group customer satisfaction. • The timely liaison with customers to ensure base/camp operating requests are considered, developed, the Optimum Conceptual Design Solution² is identified.
Compliance	• Co-ordination and compliance with the PMO function over project standards and reporting requirement and the delivery of project activity against extant systems and processes, to ensure compliance with NZDF policies, SOPs and legislative requirements. • The timely provision of information in response to parliamentary questions, Official Information Act and other requests. • The management of project delivery tasks, ensuring that capital and operating projects are delivered in accordance with NZDF and, where applicable, industry best practice, including project specifications and contract documentation. • The management and control of individual project budgets in accordance with SAP Project System guidelines.

² In this context the Optimum Conceptual Design Solution refers to a balanced outcome in terms of budget, timeline, aesthetics, maintainability, safety, legislative compliance and end user functionality.



	The monitoring of work orders to ensure compliance with ILFMS guidelines.
Health and Safety Responsibilities	- Takes all practicable steps to ensure own safety and the safety of others in all circumstances, environments and tasks. - Applies safety as an active consideration in the planning of all workplace activities. - Takes the lead in the identification of hazards, and the development of management plans. - Implements hazard management plans as required. - Maintains the currency within the workplace of all safety guidelines, instructions, practices and policies. - Ensures subordinates maintain awareness and currency of all safety policies, guidance and instructions, and enforces and guides their application as required. - Monitors the reporting of injuries and near misses, taking corrective action where required to ensure all injuries and near misses are reported. - Understands and is compliant with the Health and Safety in the Workplace Act 2015. - Proactively leads and drives a 'safety always' culture within the workplace.
Other	- The oversight of the approved budget area to ensure best use of financial resources for the operation of the DEI. - The development of and involvement in, appropriate external and internal networks to keep abreast of market practice. - Adhere to the Defence Professional Development Framework (DPDF). - Adhere to NZDF's policies, guidelines and delegations (including but not limited to the code of conduct, HR, risk, financial and commercial management). - Carry out other functions and tasks skilled and/or qualified to perform, as directed, to assist in achieving the objectives of Defence Estate and Infrastructure.

Key Working Relationships

Internal	- Facilities Management Site Supervisors and Facilities Support staff. - DEI staff. - Single Service personnel. - Base and Camp Commanders.
External	- Regional Councils. - Territorial Authorities. - Commercial Contractors and Consultants. - Service Providers. - Appropriate industry, business and government forums.

Financial Delegations

- Fin Del to appropriate CC CE: ALL Limit: \$250,000.



Decision Making Authority

- As delegated by the chain of command.

Health and Safety Responsibilities

- You are responsible for actively contributing to a safe and healthy workplace by complying with all applicable health and safety legislation, NZDF policies, procedures, and reasonable instructions. This includes taking reasonable care of your own health and safety, and that of others who may be affected by their actions or omissions. You are expected to identify hazards and risks, follow safe work practices, and promptly report hazards, incidents, injuries, and near misses through established reporting processes. Serious, significant, or unresolved risks must be escalated to the appropriate manager and/or health and safety representative. You are also expected to participate in risk assessments, training, and continuous improvement activities, and to support a positive safety culture through cooperation, accountability, and proactive communication.

Personal Specifications

To succeed in the position you must have the following:

Knowledge and Skills	• Infrastructure project management knowledge and experience. • Ability to set and maintain a high standard of quality assurance. • A working knowledge of the relevant property legislation, including the Building Act 2004, The Resource Management Act 1991, the Health and Safety in Employment Act 1992 and Health and Safety in the Workplace Act 2015. • Commercial negotiation skills. • Demonstrated computer literacy particularly project management tools and MS Office suite. • Demonstrated task/ project management skills, particularly in PRINCE2 methodology. • Desirable: A working knowledge of databases, in particular SAP/Sharepoint. • Excellent relationship management skills. • Excellent verbal and written communication skills.
Experience Level	• Experience in Project Delivery of property, facilities and/or infrastructure. • Experience in organising workflow and determining priorities.
Qualifications and Courses	• A relevant tertiary qualification in Engineering, or property/project management. Or • A relevant trade qualification supplemented with considerable industry experience and short professional courses in Project/Contract management.



Specific Job Requirements

- Ability to obtain and maintain the required level of security clearance.
- A current unencumbered motor vehicle driver's licence is essential.

NZDF Defence Professional Development Framework (DPDF) – *the over-arching holistic framework for the progressive and ongoing development of successful members.*

The following Behavioural Competencies are required to be exhibited at Civilian Grades 15-17 (Lead Leaders):

DPDF Foundation Components

Live the Ethos and Values

The NZDF values are at the heart of what the NZDF does. Strong values are prioritised, defended and something individuals least want to sacrifice. Values influence goals and form the touchstone for decision making. Internalising these values, modelling them, and instilling them in the everyday lives of the people within the workplace is a core responsibility of NZDF members. There are three key components within Live the Ethos and Values:

- Model the NZDF Ethos and Values 24/7.
- Model Self Awareness and Self Control.
- Respond with Courage and Integrity to Ethically Challenging Environments.

Leadership

Leaders at this level must focus more on scheduling and coordinating team leaders and less on individual contributor tasks. They must demonstrate effectiveness at tasking team leaders based on their skill, expertise and developmental opportunities. Leaders must provide effective coaching to develop their direct reports. They must provide clear links for their teams outputs with the greater strategic goals of the NZDF.

Effective Leaders will demonstrate an ability to think through complex decisions in a systematic way and demonstrate an understanding of second and third order consequences of their decisions.

Professional Expertise

The third component making up the DPDF foundation is Professional Expertise - the ongoing development of NZDF members to enable them to become effective, adaptable, innovative and knowledgeable in an ever changing global environment. Professional Expertise is achieved through training, education, practical 'on-the-job' experience, coaching and mentoring, assessment and self-development.

Live the Ethos and Values

- Exploits disciplinary lapses as opportunities to reinforce understanding of ethos and values to the wider group.
- Role models to peers and subordinates actions and decisions that reflect the NZDF ethos and values.
- Solicits informal feedback from members to gauge the moral and ethical health of their team.
- Explores and deepens their understanding of leadership style, impact, strengths and derailers.

Leadership

Think Smart

- Recognises and reviews tough problems from different perspectives and levels of analysis.
- Looks beyond 'symptoms', obvious patterns or superficial indicators to identify the root cause(s) of situations.
- Uses cause and effect tools to inform decision making. Develops criteria to evaluate success.
- Demonstrates flexibility: Is able to alter plans, actions or structures in order to adapt and change.
- Generates multiple solutions under pressure or in ambiguity. Ensures learning occurs after mistakes are made.
- Provides context for complex situations and articulates their intent with clarity. Coaches team leaders on delivering simple directions and decisions.



Leadership	• Maintains awareness of current and future operating environments and ensures this is understood by their members. • Uses 'cold eyes' reviews to counter familiarity, biases and assumptions.
	Influence Others • Builds trust through the effective management of systems that are essential for their teams. • Works to ensure they and their teams develop trust with the people, organisations, and communities they interact with. • Assesses, develops and if necessary, uses support structures to ensure their members and teams function effectively under pressure. • Uses facilitation skills and processes to run effective meetings. • Seeks opportunities to build social capital with members of other units, organisations or cultures in order to maximise the success of relationships. • Builds connections and collaboration across dispersed teams. • Adopts a planned approach to building networks and actively manages key relationships. • Applies mediation and negotiation as appropriate in conflict situations. Remains impartial and engaged with disputing sides over extended periods of time.
	Develop Teams • Monitors and coaches their team leaders to ensure they are applying practices and tools to effectively develop their teams, and the individuals within them, to contribute to whole of unit success. • Provides competent input to planning and decision making at the Lead Systems / Lead Capability level. • Ensures team leaders understand and fulfil their leadership responsibilities. Holds them accountable for doing so. • Prioritises time and ensures barriers are removed to enable effective development opportunities for the team. • Monitors levels of fatigue and rest / work cycles within their teams and ensures rest is built into routines. Applies the psychology of peak performance to enhance team performance. • Spends time 'on the ground' to get a real feel for what is going on; understands the level of morale, and the opportunities and problems that teams face in the performance of their mission. • Models effective leadership team relationships.
	Develop Positive Culture • Develops others' knowledge and skills in applying functional leadership. Competently demonstrates the concepts of Four Quadrant Leadership in their day-to-day tasks, exercises and deployments. • Forms a picture of leadership capability within the team using multiple sources of information and actively coaches and mentors leadership skills in future leaders. • Provides the background and reasoning to an order. • Seeks to understand the motives of others and harness them in achieving aims and outcomes. Readily adjusts approaches that do not work. • Oversees the way team leaders respond to errors and mistakes; coaches them to build a future focused, lesson learned culture. • Actively promotes and reinforces the desired culture. Engages team leaders in an active assessment of morale and culture.
	Mission Focus • Understands their leader's intent and ensures team actions are consistent with the intent. • Inspires subordinates through an engaging vision that provides purpose and a clear link to how they contribute to higher-level outputs. • Raises obstacles outside their sphere of influence with their leader. • Provides sufficient authority for those below them to perform effectively in their roles. • Accepts accountability for the work outputs, actions and behaviour of their teams.



- Translates seemingly insurmountable problems into achievable goals, remaining positive and focused on the end-state.
- Manages the desire to 'take over' delegated tasks and allows subordinate leaders to perform designated duties. Lets go of tasks not appropriate to their level of leadership.

In addition to displaying the competency expectations of lower grades, to succeed in the position Civilian Grade 15-17 members must also display the following competencies:

Professional Expertise

Resource Management - Demonstrates logical planning skills to maximise resources and efficiencies, and minimise risk. They effectively and efficiently manage work flow, maintain work standards, and use delegation to enhance individual and organisational performance. *Resource Management* at this level can be demonstrated as follows:

- Demonstrates effective planning skills.
 - Uses a structured and methodical approach to planning, utilising timelines and milestones.
 - Determines project/assignment requirements by breaking them down into tasks and identifying types of equipment, materials and people needed.
- Manages Human Resources.
 - Displays understanding and correctly employs NZDF Human Resources processes.
 - Establishes succession management strategies that will identify and retain critical people and functions.
 - Helps the right members to be in the right place, at the right time, with the right capabilities, in the right working environment.
 - Designs and/or enables practices, processes and procedures to allow managing from a distance.
 - Selects, recruits and retains the right members to contribute to the team.
 - Utilises systems and processes to retain talent within their team and the organisation.
- Maintains work standards and work safety.
 - Understands the reasoning behind key work policies, practices and procedures.
 - Sets standards and/or work procedures which achieve a high level of quality, productivity, service or safety.
 - Enforces safety regulations and procedures, and conducts regular work safety checks.
 - Detects and reports unsafe working conditions and safety problems.
 - Conducts required NZDF and national compliance training, checks and reporting.
 - Creates and manages information to a high standard of accuracy and accountability.

Professional Expertise

Performance Management – Proactively manage the performance of their subordinates, setting realistic performance objectives, and remaining informed about progress towards achieving them. They display an understanding of performance reporting systems and mechanisms, using these to address performance concerns as a means of development. *Performance Management* at this level can be demonstrated as follows:

- Displays a range of performance management skills.
 - Displays an understanding of performance reporting systems and mechanisms.
 - Uses SMART goal setting.
 - Works with direct reports to establish development plans.
 - Sets clear expectations of performance and encourages questions to ensure understanding.
- Proactively manages the performance of their subordinates.
 - Works with immediate subordinates to set meaningful performance objectives and identify SMART measures for evaluating achievement.
 - Provides specific, honest and ongoing feedback on performance.
 - Tracks performance against skill attainment and objective achievement.
 - Holds regular formal discussions with direct reports to discuss progress towards objectives and evaluate performance.
- Addresses performance concerns.



- *Promptly and directly addresses poor performance.*
- *Manages performance concerns through to resolution.*
- *Uses formal performance improvement processes when necessary.*

Personal Communications – Communicates with impact. They are articulate, displaying well-developed listening skills, questioning techniques, written communication, public speaking ability and presentation skills. They communicate with dignity and diplomacy to inspire and build confidence in others. *Personal Communication* at this level can be demonstrated as follows:

- **Business and Service writing.**
 - *Produces well researched business cases, proposals and Service papers using correct Service writing conventions.*

Signature

Position Holder's Name		
Signature		Date: ____ / ____ / 20__

Projects Officer, Defence Estate and Infrastructure

NZDF-2607025

Other

Devonport

Confidential

30/07/2026

31/07/2026

Julie Huddleston

- Varied work supporting interesting projects
- Join our supportive, inclusive and professional DEI team
- Permanent role based at Devonport Naval Base

Provide support to multiple interesting construction project projects and project teams

Mō te tūnga | About the role

We are looking for a Projects Officer to manage multiple concurrent projects annually for the NZDF. As the successful candidate, you will utilise project management methodologies and stakeholder management to ensure that the projects align with NZDF's objectives.

Your role will involve contributing to project development and planning, as well as monitoring progress throughout the delivery phase to ensure successful completion.

Ngā pūkenga me ngā wheako | Skills and Experience

We are seeking a team player with excellent organisational and communication skills and expertise in project management. In addition to this experience, you will bring a good understanding of health, safety and environmental.

If you hold a PRINCE II or equivalent qualification and may be familiar with NZS 3910 this would be advantageous.

Your skills and abilities include:

- Defining scope, budget and scheduling forecasts
- Providing monthly project status reporting
- Familiarity with SAP and/or Planview (desired but not essential)
- The ability to forge and build effective relationships with key stakeholders
- Demonstrating our core values when liaising with internal and external customers
- Excellent written/oral skills
- The ability to learn computer systems quickly or have high computer literacy
- Being able to focus and prioritise key tasks accordingly
- Previous experience in a project management role or similar

Due to the nature of this role, there is very limited options to work remotely.

The salary for this role ranges from \$88,217 to \$101,930, inclusive of a 4% superannuation contribution. Appointments within this range are based on skills and experience.

Me pāheia te tuku tōno | How to Apply

Please email internal.jobs@nzdf.mil.nz and insert as ATTACHMENTS:

- Internal Application Form
- Covering Letter
- CV

Please ensure you CLEARLY STATE in the subject line:

- NZDF-2607025 Projects Officer, DEL, Devonport
- ATTN Kerri Sterling

We'll collate the applications and forward to the Hiring Manager.

Please find position description and application form attached. For more information contact Julie Huddleston.

Please note: If you are an external contractor to NZDF, you must apply via the Defence Careers Website.

Applications close at midnight on Thursday 30 July 2026.
This position has also been posted on external websites.

Approved

Blank Fillable App Form Internal.pdf
PD_Projects Officer.pdf